

II AUTOCUE

Setup & User Manual

Automatic hot cues + deep library intelligence for Rekordbox 7.

This guide gets AutoCue running on a friend's Mac from scratch, then walks through every feature of the local app.

Local server (`autocue serve`) · Web UI at `http://localhost:7432`

Repository: github.com/HenriGeorge/AutoCue · Version 0.2.0

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Part 1 • Setup on a new machine

AutoCue reads your friend's Rekordbox database **directly** and writes hot cues back into it — no XML export/import. It runs as a small local web server on their own computer. Nothing is uploaded anywhere.

Before you start — prerequisites

REQUIREMENT	WHY / HOW
macOS (recommended)	The Rekordbox database path is auto-detected on macOS. Windows works too but needs one extra flag (see troubleshooting).
Rekordbox 6 or 7, installed & opened at least once	AutoCue reads its library. The encryption key is taken automatically from the installed Rekordbox — so it must be a real Rekordbox install.
A library that has been analyzed	In Rekordbox, tracks must have BPM + (ideally) phrase analysis run, or there will be nothing to cue.
Python 3.10 or newer	Check with <code>python3 --version</code> . If missing, install from python.org or via Homebrew (<code>brew install python</code>).

⚠ Golden rule: quit Rekordbox before writing

Rekordbox locks its database while open. AutoCue can browse/analyze, but every *write* (applying cues, deleting duplicates, saving playlists) requires Rekordbox to be **fully quit** — the app refuses the write otherwise with a clear message.

Install — step by step

- 1 **Open Terminal.** (Applications → Utilities → Terminal, or `⌘ Space` → "Terminal".)
- 2 **Get the code.** With git:

```
git clone https://github.com/HenriGeorge/AutoCue.git
cd AutoCue
```

No git? Download the ZIP from the GitHub page (green *Code* button → *Download ZIP*), unzip it, then in Terminal `cd` into the unzipped `AutoCue` folder.

- 3 **(Recommended) Create an isolated environment** so AutoCue's packages don't touch the system Python:

```
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
```

You'll see `(.venv)` at the start of the prompt. Re-run `source .venv/bin/activate` in any new Terminal before `autocue`.

- 4 **Install AutoCue.** This one command pulls everything it needs — including the SQLCipher reader for the encrypted Rekordbox DB — automatically:

```
pip install -e .
```

Optional: add YouTube download support with `pip install -e ".[download]"` (also needs `ffmpeg` on the PATH — `brew install ffmpeg`).

- 5 **Quit Rekordbox** (⌘Q — fully quit, not just close the window).

- 6 **Start AutoCue.**

```
autocue serve
```

It prints a line like `Serving on http://localhost:7432` and opens that page in the default browser. That's the app. Leave the Terminal window open while you use it; press `Ctrl C` in Terminal to stop the server.

✓ That's the whole install

No Homebrew SQLCipher, no manual key download, no build step. `pip install -e .` brings in `pyrekordbox` (which bundles the database reader), `fastapi`, and `uvicorn`. The database key is read from the Rekordbox install automatically.

What AutoCue does to stay safe

Before *any* write to the Rekordbox database, AutoCue:

- Confirms Rekordbox is **not running** — and aborts with a clear error if it is.
- Creates a **timestamped backup** at `~/ .autocue/backups/master_TIMESTAMP.db`.
- Writes inside a transaction **savepoint** that rolls back automatically on any failure.

You can roll back the most recent change from the app's **Restore backup...** button (top bar).

Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	FIX
<code>autocue:</code> command not found	The environment isn't active. Run <code>source .venv/bin/activate</code> in the AutoCue folder, or re-run <code>pip install -e .</code> .
"Rekordbox is running — close it..." (409)	Fully quit Rekordbox (⌘Q) and retry the write. Browsing/analysis works, but writes need it closed.
Database won't open / cipher / key error	Make sure Rekordbox 6/7 is actually installed and has been opened at least once on this Mac (that's where the key comes from). Then restart <code>autocue serve</code> .
No tracks shown / "0 tracks"	Analyze the library in Rekordbox first (BPM + phrase). AutoCue only sees analyzed tracks.

Port already in use	Run on another port: <code>autocue serve --port 8080</code> (then open <code>localhost:8080</code>).
Windows machine	The DB path isn't auto-detected — pass it explicitly: <code>autocue serve --db-path</code> <code>"C:\Users\you\AppData\Roaming\Pioneer\rekordbox\master.db"</code>
Python too old	<code>python3 --version</code> must be ≥ 3.10 . Install a newer Python and recreate the <code>.venv</code> .
Something looks wrong after a write	Use Restore backup... in the app, or copy a file from <code>~/.autocue/backups/</code> back over <code>master.db</code> (Rekordbox closed).

Updating & removing

- **Update:** in the AutoCue folder, `git pull` then `pip install -e .` again.
- **Remove:** stop the server, delete the `AutoCue` folder. Backups in `~/.autocue/` can be deleted separately.

Part 2 · Using AutoCue

When AutoCue opens it lands on the **Crate Console** — a dense, keyboard-friendly workbench.

`local mode`

The layout

- **Left rail** — crates (All tracks, No cues yet, Phrase-ready, Already cued), your Rekordbox **playlists**, saved filters, and a library-health ring.
- **Centre** — the track grid (one thin row per track: #, title/artist, BPM, key, energy, mix score, class, cues).
- **Right** — the **inspector drawer**. Click any row and it slides in from the right with that track's energy curve, scores, cues, a ► **Play** button, and a "find similar" action. Click another row to switch focus; it clears when you open a rail place (Library / Duplicates / Discover).
- **Top bar** — playlist filter, analysis-mode toggle, Restore backup, Open Nightboard, and a live status sentence.
- `⌘ K` — command palette: jump to any place or action by typing.

Placing hot cues (the core job)

- 1 **Pick tracks.** Tick rows in the grid, or use a crate/playlist to scope the set. (No selection = the current filtered set.)
- 2 **Choose a mode** in the top bar: **Bar intervals** (a cue every N bars from bar 1) or ✨ **Phrase analysis** (cues at detected Intro / Verse / Drop / Bridge / Outro boundaries — needs Rekordbox phrase data).
- 3 **Preview.** AutoCue shows the cues it *would* write as coloured badges on each card, with a confidence level and a reasoning pop-up (the **i** button).

- 4 **Apply** (Rekordbox quit). Cues are written straight into the Rekordbox database after an automatic backup. Re-open Rekordbox to see them.

Cue colours (phrase mode)

Intro = green · Verse = blue · Drop = red · Bridge = cyan · Outro = orange · Build = pink. Slots are ordered A→H with a memory cue (CDJ Auto Cue) first.

Previewing audio

Select a track and press ► **Play** in the inspector drawer to hear it (the original file must still be on disk). A green playhead traces the energy curve as it plays; press again to pause.

Library tools (the "Library" rail place)

TOOL	WHAT IT GIVES YOU
Health check	A 0–100 library score + a list of issues (missing cues, no beat grid, no phrase analysis, duplicate or unnamed cues...), with one-click fixes. The overall score rolls up when a scan finishes.
Energy & mixability	Per-track energy curve and a 0–100 mixability score (how easy it is to blend) with an animated breakdown.
Classification	Sorts each track into DJ-set roles (warm-up, build, peak, etc.).
Similar tracks	Finds harmonically + energetically close tracks (6-dimension match with a BPM gate).
Transition scoring	Scores how well any two tracks mix (BPM 40% · key 35% · energy 25%) with advice.
Set builder	Beam-search a full set from a start track, target BPM curve, duration, and energy mode.
Cue tools · Discogs · Comments · Playlist suggest	Bulk cue cleanup, Discogs metadata enrichment, comment/My-Tag enrichment, and category-based playlist suggestions.

Other places & modes

- **Duplicates** (rail) — finds duplicate tracks by artist/title/length, picks the best keeper (you can override), and safely deletes the rest with a backup + inline undo.
- **Discover** (rail) — surfaces new releases based on the artists and labels you already play (plus a novelty feed); save, dismiss, or snooze.
- **Nightboard** (top bar → Open Nightboard) — a full-screen set-building canvas: tiles for tracks, scored "joints" between them, swap/insert alternatives, then export to a playlist.
- **Drag-to-playlist** — drag any grid row onto a playlist in the left rail to add it (the row glows green as a valid target; the count pops on drop). Rekordbox must be quit.
- **Restore backup** (top bar) — roll back the last database change.

The command-line alternative

Prefer the terminal? `autocue --library --dry-run` previews cues for the whole library without writing; drop `--dry-run` to generate a Rekordbox-importable XML instead of writing to the database. The local server in this guide is the recommended path — it is the only mode with the intelligence features above (health, mixability, similar, transitions, set builder, Discover, Nightboard). (A browser-only XML-in / XML-out web app also exists in the project, but it is not currently hosted at a public URL — run the local server instead.)

Part 3 · Quick reference

COMMAND	DOES
<code>autocue serve</code>	Start the local app at localhost:7432 (opens the browser).
<code>autocue serve --port 8080</code>	Use a different port.
<code>autocue serve --no-browser</code>	Start without opening a browser.
<code>autocue serve --db-path "... master.db"</code>	Point at a specific database (required on Windows).
<code>autocue serve --reset-cache</code>	Delete the analysis cache at startup (it's rebuilt lazily as you use the app).
<code>autocue --library --dry-run</code>	CLI: preview cues for the whole library (no writes).
<code>⌘ K</code>	Command palette (jump anywhere / run any action).
<code>Esc</code>	Close the inspector drawer / dialogs.
<code>Ctrl C</code> (in Terminal)	Stop the server.

Remember: quit Rekordbox before any write · backups live in `~/ .autocue/backups/` · nothing leaves the machine.